

South Indian Meal Plan

7-Day Practical & Economical Diet Guide

Assumptions & Safety Note

- Dietary & Activity Assumptions:** As the exercise type was not specified, the plan is designed around incidental daily movement typical of a lightly active routine. The vegetarian requirement is interpreted as lacto-vegetarian, which is standard for South Indian cooking and includes dairy but excludes eggs.
- Safety Note:** This meal plan provides general nutrition education to support gradual, sustainable fat loss. It is not intended to diagnose, treat, or cure any medical condition. Please consult a registered dietitian or healthcare provider before making significant dietary changes.

Meal Plan (Days 1-4)

DAY	MEAL	DISH	PORTION
Day 1	Breakfast	Idli with Tiffin Sambar	4 medium idlis, 1 cup sambar
Day 1	Lunch	Sona Masoori Rice, Toor Dal, Carrot-Beans Poriyal	1 cup rice, 3/4 cup dal, 1 cup poriyal
Day 1	Snack	Filter Coffee and Spiced Puffed Rice (Pori)	1 small cup coffee, 1.5 cups pori
Day 1	Dinner	Godhumai Dosa (Whole Wheat) with Tomato Chutney	3 dosas, 2 tbsp chutney
Day 2	Breakfast	Rava Upma with Mixed Vegetables (Carrot, Beans, Peas)	1.5 cups upma
Day 2	Lunch	Leftover Rice, Leftover Dal, and Cucumber Slices	1 cup rice, 3/4 cup dal, 1 cup cucumber
Day 2	Snack	Neer Mor (Spiced Buttermilk) and Roasted Peanuts	1 glass buttermilk, 2 tbsp peanuts
Day 2	Dinner	Store-bought Batter Dosa with Leftover Tomato Chutney	3 dosas, 2 tbsp chutney

Meal Plan (Days 5-7)

DAY	MEAL	DISH	PORTION
Day 5	Breakfast	Poha (Aval) Upma with Peanuts and Curry Leaves	1.5 cups upma
Day 5	Lunch	Sona Masoori Rice, Keerai Masiyal (Spinach), Tomato Rasam	1 cup rice, 3/4 cup masiyal, 1/2 cup rasam
Day 5	Snack	Fresh Guava and a Glass of Water	1 medium fruit
Day 5	Dinner	Leftover Lemon Rice with Boiled Moong Sprout Salad	1.5 cups lemon rice, 1 cup salad
Day 6	Breakfast	Store-bought Batter Idli with Peanut Chutney	4 medium idlis, 2 tbsp chutney
Day 6	Lunch	Leftover Rice, Leftover Keerai Masiyal, Plain Curd	1 cup rice, 3/4 cup masiyal, 1/2 cup curd
Day 6	Snack	Filter Coffee and Roasted Chana (Pottukadalai)	1 small cup coffee, 3 tbsp chana
Day 6	Dinner	Adai (Lentil Pancake) with Jaggery and Curd	2 medium adais, 1 tbsp jaggery, 2 tbsp curd
Day 7	Breakfast	Leftover Adai with Tomato-Onion Thokku	2 medium adais, 2 tbsp thokku
Day 7	Lunch	Bisi Bele Bath (Sambar Rice) with Carrot Raita	1.5 cups rice, 3/4 cup raita
Day 7	Snack	Black Chana Sundal (Kondakadalai) and Buttermilk	3/4 cup sundal, 1 glass buttermilk
Day 7	Dinner	Phulka with Dal Tadka	3 phulkas, 1 cup dal

Practical Notes for Your Routine

- **Hydration Routine:** Waking at 5:00 am offers a great head start on hydration. Begin the morning with a large glass of water, and keep a refillable bottle at the office desk to ensure 2.5 to 3 litres of fluid intake across the 9-hour workday.
- **Time-Saving Strategy:** To stick strictly to a 30-minute weekday cooking limit, rely heavily on the "cook once, eat twice" method shown in the plan (e.g., eating leftover dinner items for the next day's lunch). Purchasing high-quality, fresh idli/dosa batter from a standard local grocery market is an economical way to save substantial preparation time.
- **Affordable Sourcing:** Lean on local, seasonal vegetables such as bottle gourd, snake gourd, cabbage, and seasonal greens (keerai) which are highly economical and widely available in local markets or the nearest Uzhavar Santhai in Coimbatore. Adjust the vegetable choices in kootus and poriyals based on whatever is freshest and most budget-friendly that week.